

Exploring Donald Trump's rhetoric in the Trump Twitter Archive

Goal: Understand Donald Trump's rhetoric, phraseology, and manipulative strategies (in case he comes back for the 2024 election ... *oh dear!*)

- we will take a practical look at a corpus of Donald Trump's tweets (from TTA) together
- session should be interactive, ask students at each step what they suggest to do

Access: https://corpora.linguistik.uni-erlangen.de/cqpweb/tta_full/

Step 1: give quick tour of CQPweb basics with query **make america great again**, including frequency information, paging, random ordering, metadata, context

Step 2: other concordances are harder to interpret, e.g. **great** (most of it isn't MAGA), **sorting** on 1R and **frequency breakdown** helps a little → used quite generally with different nouns + *great again*

Step 3: another concordance: **alleged*** (*alleged, allegedly*); this is surprising vocabulary for Donald Trump, but do you notice something?
→ select a suitable **subcorpus** (only original tweets: no retweets, replies, etc.)

Step 4: how do we get further ideas for interesting starting points, i.e. additional nodes for our corpus analysis?
keyword analysis = frequency comparison against reference corpus (→ English tweets); settings: compare **lemma**, show **positive keywords**, **log-likelihood** statistic → focus on salient *fake* (in addition to very frequent *great* from above)

Step 5: click on concordance for *fake* with expectation that it's mostly *fake news*; but top of concordance looks different → why? (because we didn't randomise!); expectation confirmed by frequency breakdown on 1R (*fake news* 75%)

Step 6: query **fake news** as new node (subcorpus: Originals), quick look at concordance
→ > 900 hits, still requiring a quantitative analysis to get overview

Step 7: **distribution analysis** for *fake news* (esp. distribution across years is interesting)
→ importance of combining insights from metadata with concordance reading

Step 8: can you see further patterns in the concordance? what might help?
collocation analysis for *fake news* reveals usage and phraseology; explain how to explore collocations in CQPweb, then look at different AMs

Step 9: corpus query as part of the concordance reading process (incl. subcorpus selection); we have already "zoomed in" on interesting MWE patterns; can you think of other phraseology or rhetoric we could match with queries?
(1) **tax cut**, (2) **tax {cut}**, (3) **(so)? sad \!**, or (4) **(\U){3,}** + longest match